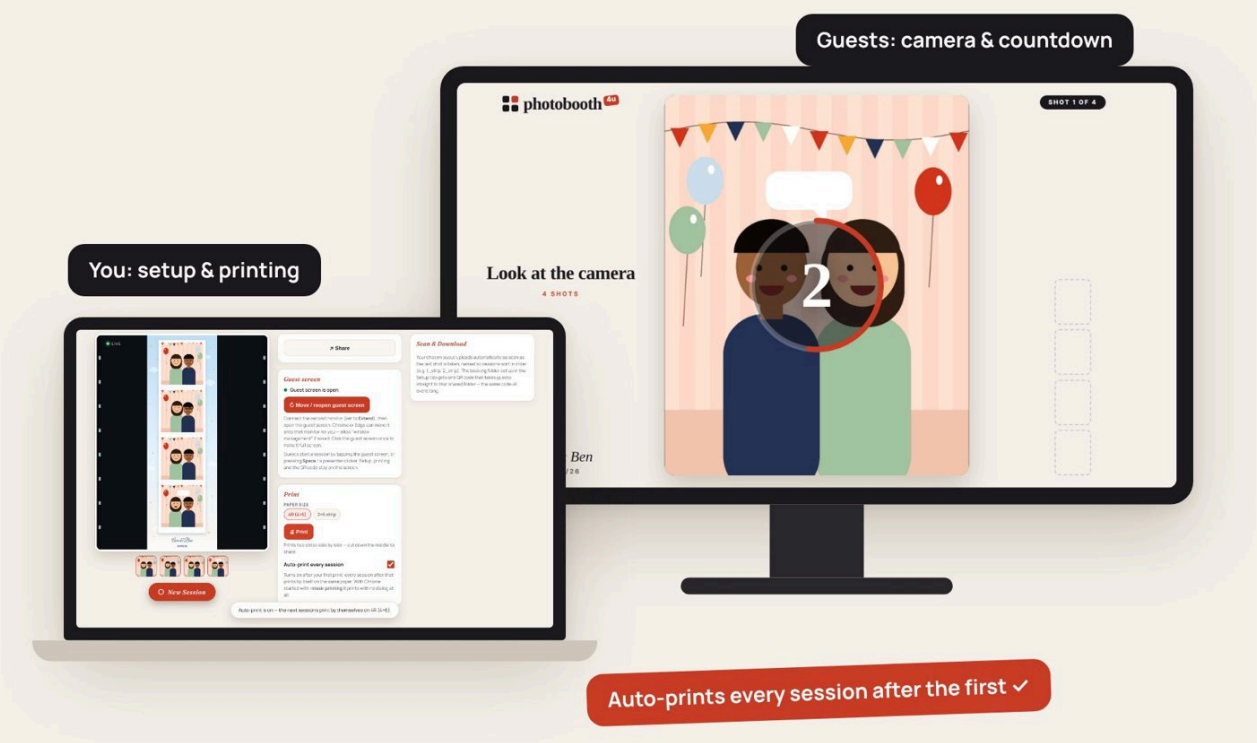
photobooth 4u

Your booth, *ready* for any event.

Everything you need to run photobooth4u. In a hurry? **Page 2 is a one-page quick start** for event day. The rest explains each part step by step.



★ Quick start (page 2)

01 What you need

02 Unlock your devices

03 Set up each event

04 Pro Booth: laptop + guest screen

05 Use your DSLR / mirrorless camera

06 Running a photo session

07 Printing (one or two printers)

08 Backup folder & pro tips

09 After the event: send the photos

10 Troubleshooting & help

★ EVENT DAY

Quick start

Do these in order. Each step has its own page if you need more detail.

1. ### Plug everything in

   Laptop on its charger. Guest screen by HDMI, set to **Extend**. Camera on a full battery (or dummy battery), lens cap off. Printer on, paper and ribbon loaded.

2. ### Camera: set the USB mode

   Canon: camera Menu → **Choose USB connection app** → **Photo Import / Remote Control**, and turn the camera's Wi-Fi / Bluetooth off. **Nikon:** nothing to set. Then connect the USB cable to the laptop. *(Page 6)*

3. ### Open the booth in Chrome

   Start Chrome with the **silent-printing shortcut** (page 5) and open **photobooth4u.netlify.app**.

4. ### Choose the camera

   Setup → 5 Share & start → Camera → DSLR / mirrorless over USB (remote control). Chrome shows a list: pick your camera → **Connect**. The live view appears.

5. ### Check Setup

   Design, name and date, layout, frame, and the **event name** in step 5 Share. It's saved from last time, so usually you only change the name.

6. ### Choose the printers

   In the **Print** box pick each paper size and its printer. Two printers or HiTi strips: open the **Print Helper** first (page 8).

7. ### Do one test session and print

   Take a session yourself. Check the photo, the QR code and the print. Then tick **Auto-print every session** if you want it.

8. ### Open the guest screen

   In **Setup → 5**, tap **Open guest screen**, click it once for full screen. You're ready. Guests tap the screen or press the clicker to start.

Keys & clicker

- `Space` / `Enter` / clicker: start, next photo, skip the wait, **Done**
- `Esc`: cancel the session

If something goes wrong

- Camera stuck: unplug and replug the USB, tap **Try Again**.
- Anything else: reload the page. Your setup is saved.
- Still stuck: page 10, or message us.

01 · BEFORE YOU START

What you need

CLASSIC BOOTH

- **iPad or Android tablet** (a phone works too)
- **Tripod or stand** at the guests' eye level
- **Internet**: venue Wi-Fi or a phone hotspot
- *Optional:* photo printer, if your package includes printing

PRO BOOTH

- **Laptop** with **Chrome or Edge**, and a camera: built-in, USB webcam, or your **DSLR / mirrorless** camera (page 6)
- **Second monitor or TV** + HDMI cable, facing the guests
- *Optional:* presenter clicker, so guests can start a shot
- *Optional:* photo printer (4R / 4×6 recommended)

Day-before checklist

- ☐ Device charged, charger packed
- ☐ Booth opens and the camera works
- ☐ Internet tested at (or near) the venue
- ☐ Event name decided (you type it in Setup)
- ☐ Printer + paper loaded, one test print done
- ☐ Pro Booth: HDMI cable and guest screen tested

02 · FIRST TIME ON EACH DEVICE

Unlock your devices

1. **Open the booth**

   Go to **photobooth4u.netlify.app** in Chrome, Edge or Safari.

2. **Enter your code**

   Type your `PB-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` code and tap **Unlock**. Lifetime codes open your **My Events** page first, so tap **Open photo booth** from there.

3. **That device is now yours**

   It stays unlocked, so next time just open the website. Each new device uses one of your **device slots**. To replace a device (new laptop, lost tablet), message us and we'll free its slot.

Keep your code private. Anyone with it can use your device slots and see your event links.

03 · EVERY EVENT

Set up each event

In the booth, open **Setup** and go through the 5 steps with **Next**. The bar at the bottom shows what's still needed and has **Start photo session**.

1 Design

Under **Ready designs**, tap a template to see it big, then **Use this design**. **Colours & background** changes the background, gold details colour or adds your own photo. ★ **Save my design** keeps yours for next time.

2 Text

Type the **name on the photo** and tap the **calendar icon** to add the date. Pick a title style, then a font: the cards show your own name. **Pairs** set the name and small-line fonts together.

3 Layout

Pick one of the **layouts** (each card shows your design) and the countdown. Optional: **guests choose the layout** each session.

4 Extras

All optional, in tabs. **Frame**: upload your Canva frame with the photo spots left white or see-through. It becomes **My frame**, and two or more make a **Frame collage** on one 4R print. A frame with two strips side by side? Tick **Same photos on both strips** so guests take 3 photos, not 6. **Logo**, **Stickers**, and **Filter** (B&W, Sepia, Warm, Cool, soft skin).

5 Share

Lifetime codes: type the **event name** for a new folder. **Rental codes** connect by themselves. The **All photos** QR is here to print or share ahead. On a laptop, choose a **backup folder** here too (page 9).



Built-in layouts, plus your own frames.

SAVES BY ITSELF

Your setup saves automatically. It comes back after a refresh or restart, and **every device on your code gets the same design**. Lifetime codes keep a separate design for each event name. ··· → **Reset setup** starts fresh.

USING MORE THAN ONE DEVICE?

Type the **exact same event name** on every device at that event. They share one folder, one QR code and one design. Each device's photos end in its number (`…_cam1.jpg`, `…_cam2.jpg`).

04 · PRO BOOTH

Laptop + guest screen

Guests see the camera, countdown and their photos on the big screen. You run setup, printing and the QR code on the laptop.

1. **Connect the second screen**

   Plug in the monitor or TV. Set the display to **Extend**, not Duplicate. Windows: press `Win + P` → **Extend**. Mac: System Settings → Displays → turn off mirroring.

2. **Start Chrome with silent printing**

   Use the shortcut below so prints go straight to the printer without a pop-up. Close every Chrome window first.

3. **Open the guest screen**

   In **Setup → 5 Share & start**, tap **Open guest screen**. Allow pop-ups and "window management" if Chrome asks. It moves to the second screen. Click it once to go full screen.

4. **Let guests start**

   Guests tap the guest screen, or press `Space` / `Enter` or a presenter clicker.



You: setup and printing. Guests: camera and countdown.

Silent-printing shortcut

Windows: right-click the desktop → New → Shortcut, and paste this as the location:

```
"C:\Program Files\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe" --kiosk-printing
https://photobooth4u.netlify.app/
```

Mac: open Terminal and run:

```
open -a "Google Chrome" --args --kiosk-printing https://photobooth4u.netlify.app/
```

Don't add `--kiosk` for the Pro Booth. It forces a single full-screen window and blocks the guest screen. Edge works the same way with `msedge.exe`.

05 · PRO BOOTH CAMERA

Use your DSLR / mirrorless camera

USB remote control is the best way: the booth presses the real shutter, so your **camera settings, focus and flash all work**. Works on a **Mac** in **Chrome or Edge** (Canon, Nikon, Sony, Fujifilm and most others).

1 Set the camera

Canon: Menu → **Choose USB connection app** → **Photo Import / Remote Control** (not "Video calls / streaming"). Turn off Wi-Fi / Bluetooth. **Nikon / others:** nothing to set. Save photos as **JPEG** (or RAW + JPEG), and turn off **auto power off**.

2 Plug in and connect

Use the camera's USB cable straight into the laptop. Quit **Photos**, **Image Capture** and **EOS Utility** if they open. In the booth: **Setup → 5 Share & start → Camera → DSLR / mirrorless over USB** → pick the camera → **Connect**.

3 Set your look

Choose the mode, exposure, white balance and flash **on the camera**, like a normal shoot. The booth uses them for every photo. Use continuous / face AF.

4 Mirror

Mirror (Camera section, or the button on the Get ready screen) flips the preview. The final photo **looks exactly like the preview**: mirrored when it's on, not mirrored when it's off.

Good to know

- **Test it first:** open **photobooth4u.netlify.app/camera-test/**. If it shows a live view and takes a photo, the booth will too.
- Keep the battery charged, or use a **dummy battery**. A low battery can stop the live view.
- **Windows** needs a one-time driver switch: follow the Windows camera test page.
- **No USB remote?** Webcam mode still works (Canon EOS Webcam Utility, Sony USB Streaming, or an HDMI capture card), but the flash won't fire and camera settings don't apply.

06 · SHOWTIME

Running a photo session

What guests see, step by step. You can stay hands-off: everything works with taps on the guest screen or a clicker.

1. **Start & pick a layout**

   The guest taps **Start** (or the welcome screen). If you allowed it, they choose a layout.

2. **Get ready**

   The live view shows how many photos and the time between them. Guests can pick a **filter** and **Mirror** here. Tap **Start** on the picture (or `Space`) when ready.

3. **Countdown & photos**

   Each photo shows for the **pause** you set, so guests can check it. `Space` skips the wait. The photos appear one by one at the side.

4. **Review: retake or Done**

   Not happy with one? **Tap that photo** on the side, then **Retake**. Happy? Tap **Done** (or `Space`). **Cancel** or `Esc` stops the session; nothing is saved.

5. **Finished photo**

   The final print shows with its **QR code**. It uploads, saves a copy and prints (if Auto-print is on). **Next guest** clears the screen.

Setup → 3 Layout → More timer options

- **Between photos:** *Continue by itself*, or *Wait for a tap* so guests press for each next photo.
- **Pause between photos:** how long each photo shows before the next countdown.
- **Extra time before photo 1:** gives the group time to get in place.
- The finished photo stays until **Next guest** is tapped.

DURING THE EVENT

GUESTS

Follow the countdown and pose. Scan the **Your photo** QR to open the photo in the online gallery.

PHOTOS

Each session uploads to the event's **online gallery**, and a copy saves on the laptop: **Downloads**, or your **backup folder**.

YOU

Print the **All photos** QR from Setup → Share and put it near the booth. Guests can scan it any time.

07 · IF YOUR PACKAGE INCLUDES PRINTING

Printing

One printer, one size? Do steps 1, 2 and 5. **Two printers, or 4R photos and 2×6 strips on the same HiTi?** Do all five.

1. ### Set up the printer on the laptop

   Install its driver and print one test page. In the printer's own preferences set the **paper size** (e.g. 6×4) and **borderless**. The booth prints with these settings.

2. ### For strips, add the printer a second time

   Strips print two side by side on one 4R sheet. Add the same HiTi again (Mac: System Settings → Printers → **+**; Windows: Printers → Add) and name it e.g. `HiTi 2x6 cut`. Give that copy the driver's **2-inch cut** paper option, so the printer cuts the sheet into two strips. Name the first copy `HiTi 4x6`.

3. ### Open the Print Helper

   Download it from **photobooth4u.netlify.app/downloads/**, unzip and open it (Mac: right-click → **Open** the first time; Windows: **More info** → **Run anyway**). Leave its window open during the event.

4. ### Choose a printer for each size

   In the booth's **Print** box, switch on **Print Helper on this computer** (click **Allow** if Chrome asks). Tap each paper size and pick its printer under **Printer for …**. Strip layouts use the **2 strips, cut** printer by themselves. The booth remembers your choices.

5. ### Test, then Auto-print

   Print one session of each size. Then tick **Auto-print every session**: each print goes straight to the right printer with no pop-up.

Good to know

- Without the Print Helper, the booth uses Chrome's printing. Start Chrome with the **silent-printing shortcut** (page 5), which always prints to the laptop's **default printer**.
- A print dialog still opens? Choose the photo printer, set **Margins: None** and **Scale: 100%**.
- Only the paper sizes in your package appear in the Print box.

08 · PRO BOOTH BACKUP

Backup folder & weak internet

1. **Choose a backup folder**

   In **Setup → 5 Share**, tap **Choose backup folder** and pick one, e.g. **Pictures › photobooth4u**. Every photo is saved there in a subfolder named after the event. Chrome or Edge on a computer.

2. **Allow saving after a restart**

   After Chrome restarts, tap **Allow saving** (in Setup or the Photo Session panel), then allow Chrome to edit files.

3. **Check it's on**

   The Photo Session panel shows **Backup folder: Saving to … ✓**. Without one, each photo goes to **Downloads**.

INTERNET DROPS?

The booth tries again, then **keeps the photo on the device**. The panel shows **Waiting to upload**, and the photos upload by themselves when the internet is back. Guests get the **All photos** QR meanwhile. Keep the booth open until the list is empty.

BEFORE GUESTS ARRIVE

Pro tips

- Put the camera at eye level, with light facing the guests (not behind them).
- Keep the device plugged in. The booth keeps the screen awake while it's open; on tablets, also turn off auto-lock.
- Weak venue internet? Use a phone hotspot. Photos that can't upload wait on the device and upload by themselves later.

09 · AFTER THE EVENT

Send the photos to your client

1. **Open My Events**

   Go to **photobooth4u.netlify.app/lifetime/** on any phone or computer and sign in with your code. Every event is listed, newest first.

2. **Copy or show the link**

   Use **Copy link** to send the **online gallery** by Messenger, or **Show QR** to let your client scan it. **Drive folder** opens the same photos in Google Drive for downloading them all.

3. **Remind them to download**

   Photos are deleted **7 days after the event's last photo**. Each event shows its "Download by" date.

7-DAY RULE

Send the link the same day, and tell your client to save their favourites within the week. After deletion the link stops working.

10 · QUICK FIXES

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
"We need access to your camera"	Allow camera access in the browser (the icon in the address bar), then tap **Try Again**. Close other apps using the camera.
"Camera disconnected. Reconnecting…"	Check the camera is on and its USB cable is in. The booth carries on by itself.
USB camera not in Chrome's list	Canon: set **Photo Import / Remote Control** and turn off Wi-Fi. Quit Photos / Image Capture / EOS Utility, replug the cable, reload.
"The camera photo didn't come through"	The camera couldn't focus, or saves RAW only. Set JPEG and check focus. The live view picture was used instead.
"Print Helper not found"	Open the Print Helper app and keep its window open. Allow access if Chrome asks.
"Photos waiting to upload"	The internet dropped. They upload by themselves, or tap **Retry now** / **Save to this computer**.
"Already used on another device"	All your device slots are taken. Message us to free one.
The QR code doesn't appear	Check the internet, and make sure the event name is typed in Setup → 5 Share.
A print dialog pops up every time	Use the Print Helper (page 8), or start Chrome with the silent-printing shortcut (page 5).
Guest screen is on the wrong monitor	Check the display is set to **Extend**, then tap **Move / reopen guest screen**.

Need help? Message us.

We're on Facebook Messenger: **m.me/roktetnachi**

Message us